

A close look at the Android OS and the Open Handset Alliance -- will it change the way we look at phones?

The cloud-based, free (AGPLv3) operating system



Safari 4 home screen showing the Top Sites

don't want to leave a digital trail behind, there's the option of using Private Browsing akin to Chrome's Incognito mode.

The improvements however are not all visual dazzle. There are improvements under the hood and even in terms of usability. An example of a usability tweak is the ability to grab tabs into new windows; again this one comes from Chrome. The Java script engine Nitro, has gone through a revamp with this version contributing greatly to its speed and stability.

Now for the speed. Since Safari is so similar to Chrome (uses the same rendering engine) we decided to pit it against only that browser for the speed comparison. Besides, Chrome is also regarded as the strongest contender to the title of "fastest

browser around" so we figure it should be an interesting bout. For some quick results we put both browsers through a benchmark and a real world page loading test. The browser benchmark tool from future mark is quite popular. It is a six step test process that takes the browser through the grind of

while Safari gets a complete 100. This makes it only the second browser yet to hit the mark.

As for the page loading test we decided to note the time taken to load a single tab of thinkdigit.com. To time it we used the XNote stopwatch application which was started simultaneously with a mouse

click corresponding to hitting the enter key for the address bar of the browser. The results were quite inconclusive as both browsers did a mighty fine job of rendering the page quickly. As for start up time however, Chrome was much faster on our system.

What about memory usage? Some memory usage charts online showed Safari 4 to be significantly low on resource consumption, coming in very close to Opera. When we checked our process manager with three tabs open pointing to thinkdigit for both Safari and Chrome, we found Chrome to be lighter. Oh well, the complaint for bloatware is always there, but as long as the application is fast and does what it's supposed to, we're not too bothered.

Indian web startups back again?

Since the dot com bust of yesteryears, several interesting concepts remained just that

– interesting concepts. For a while now webpreneurs have been venture shy, but things have probably started looking up. This month, we came across two new startups that seem quite interesting and worth checking out.

TweetKnot is a Bangalore-based web startup that offers a simple way of creating groups or communities on Twitter. The groups are called Knots. Every member of Knot can send messages to all other members. There are options to make private knots and even select the members whose updates will appear in a knot. To use the service you will have to give TweetKnot access to your Twitter account. TweetKnot seems somewhat similar to another service we had come across called Twibe. Yet, unlike Twibe's clunky appearance, TweetKnot's interface seems like a natural extension of Twitter. You can post updates to groups from tweetknot.com or even from your Twitter account using the syntax [D TweetKnot <knotname>]. Now, although it's a fun utility, what comes to mind is whether the creators have any revenue model in mind, since that is a question even Twitter itself is still struggling with.

The other startup, Zimblee.com, isn't confused in that area at all. Zimblee is a tool that allows you to create online ad campaigns and schedule them to appear on different social networking web sites such as BigAdda. Apparently, it's the world's first custom online ad creator platform that is meant for use by advertisers, including individuals and small businesses. The tool is intended to be a do-it-yourself ad maker. The service itself seems pretty easy to use. The online demo gives a complete walk through of how advertisers can create their display ads, literally within a few clicks. And all this doesn't cost the earth. They have packages that start from as low as Rs. 12,000. **[d]**

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loading, sorting and searching for data and even measures your browser's ability to render and modify specific HTML elements used in typical web pages,

amongst other things. On a P4 system running Windows 7 Safari 4 secured 1,999 Points, while chrome got 1,748. Interestingly, the overall scores accumulated on the web site also



Zimblee ad creator in action